

ing the nature of the underlying rights and interests at stake. The Court waxes eloquent on the blend of prudential and constitutional considerations that combine to create our misguided "standing" jurisprudence. *But not one word is said about the Establishment Clause right that the plaintiff seeks to enforce.* And despite its pat recitation of our standing decisions, the opinion utterly fails, except by the sheerest form of *ipse dixit*, to explain why this case is unlike *Flast v. Cohen*, 392 U. S. 83 (1968), and is controlled instead by *Frothingham v. Mellon*, 262 U. S. 447 (1923).

I

There is now much in the way of settled doctrine in our understanding of the injury-in-fact requirement of Art. III. At the core is the irreducible minimum that persons seeking judicial relief from an Art. III court have "such a personal stake in the outcome of the controversy as to assure that concrete adverseness which sharpens the presentation of issues upon which the court so largely depends" *Baker v. Carr*, 369 U. S. 186, 204 (1962). See *Duke Power Co. v. Carolina Environmental Study Group, Inc.*, 438 U. S. 59, 72 (1978). Cases of this Court have identified the two essential components of this "personal stake" requirement. Plaintiff must have suffered, or be threatened with, some "distinct and palpable injury," *Warth v. Seldin*, 422 U. S. 490, 501 (1975). In addition, there must be some causal connection between plaintiff's asserted injury and defendant's challenged action. *Simon v. Eastern Kentucky Welfare Rights Org.*, 426 U. S. 26, 41 (1976); *Arlington Heights v. Metropolitan Housing Dev. Corp.*, 429 U. S. 252, 261 (1977). The Constitution requires an Art. III court to ascertain that both requirements are met before proceeding to exercise its authority on behalf of any plaintiff, whether the form of relief requested is equitable or monetary.

But the existence of Art. III injury "often turns on the nature and source of the claim asserted." *Warth v. Seldin*,